

Tier 2 Revenue Accelerator Report

Scale from \$2M to Pro Contender

Section 1 — The 7 KPIs Blocking Your Next Jump:

1. Event ROI under 2x

Action: Before booking any themed night or special event, define the exact revenue it needs to generate to justify its cost — ticket revenue, incremental concession lift, and sponsor activation fees combined. After the event, run an actual versus target comparison. Most teams at this budget level run events without a defined return threshold, which means profitable and unprofitable events look identical on the calendar. Establishing a minimum 2x return as a go/no-go filter before confirming events will, over time, eliminate the programming that drains budget without moving the needle.

2. Sponsor churn over 25%

Action: After each season, conduct a debrief call with every sponsor that did not renew. Ask directly: what would have made this worth continuing? The most common answer at this budget level is that sponsors could not measure what they received. Address this by delivering a one-page post-season performance report for each partner that documents PA mentions, estimated social impressions, logo placements, and any in-stadium activation results. Sponsors who receive documented performance data renew at significantly higher rates than those who do not.

3. ARPA between \$22–30

Action: Introduce event-specific programming on two to three designated home games per season — a local DJ set, a themed food and drink menu, a pre-game watch-party format. These layered experiences give fans a reason to arrive earlier and spend more before tip-off. Teams that add even one deliberate experiential layer per event consistently report higher per-head spend on those nights compared to standard game days.

4. Attendance between 1,500–3,000

Action: Segment your attendance data by day of week, opponent, and promotional type. If you are not already doing this, start now. Most teams at this level will find that a small number of game configurations — typically weekend slots with a giveaway or themed night — drive a disproportionate share of high-attendance nights. Concentrate your promotional investment in those configurations and scale back spend on the slots that consistently underperform.

5. Sponsor revenue at 20–30% of total

Action: If sponsor revenue is at or below 30% of total, the ceiling is most likely your number of active sponsors, not the size of individual deals. Build a category exclusivity matrix — one sponsor per vertical, meaning one auto dealer, one insurance brand, one restaurant group, and so on. Sell category exclusivity as a premium and use it to justify higher contract values. This structure also makes renewal conversations easier because sponsors are not competing for the same audience attention within your inventory.

6. POS overload causing peak abandonment

Action: Identify your two highest-traffic concession windows — pre-game and halftime. At those windows specifically, deploy mobile POS operators to walk the queue and take

orders before fans reach the counter. This is the most cost-effective intervention before committing to kiosk infrastructure. Research shows that 45% of fans abandon lines they perceive as too long, and that reducing wait time at peak windows increases per-fan spend significantly.

7. Estimated annual revenue leak of \$500k+

Action: Do not treat this as a single problem. Break the leak into its component sources — abandoned concession transactions, unconverted ticket leads, sponsor churn, and below-benchmark per-head spend — and assign a rough dollar estimate to each. Address the largest source first. Teams that attempt to fix revenue leakage across all categories simultaneously rarely move the needle because resources and attention get spread too thin to create measurable impact in any single area.

Section 2 — Proven Plays to Lift ARPA to \$35:

1. Slash wait times at peak hours with better POS distribution

Action: Conduct a timed audit at your next home game during the pre-game and halftime windows. Count how many fans enter the concession queue and how many exit without purchasing. If you are losing more than one in four fans to line abandonment, add a mobile POS operator to that corridor before the next game. This is a same-week fix that does not require infrastructure investment — one trained staff member with a tablet is all that is needed to begin recovering those transactions.

2. Lock in sponsor retention with performance-based contracts

Action: When renewing or signing sponsors for the upcoming season, introduce a simple performance structure: a guaranteed base fee with a bonus tier unlocked when specific deliverables are hit — for example, a social post reaching a defined impression threshold, or a PA activation tied to a measurable in-game outcome. Performance-based structures reduce churn because sponsors are paying for outcomes they can see rather than making a blind annual commitment.

3. Layer in event programming to lift per-head spend

Action: Select two to three home games next season and add one deliberate experience layer — a local food vendor pop-up, a pre-game DJ set, a themed drink special tied to the night's promotion. Track your concession revenue on those nights against a comparable standard game night. If the per-head lift is measurable, expand the format. If it is not, adjust the layer and test again. The goal is to find the specific one or two programming additions that your fan base actually responds to, not to over-program every night.

Section 3 — The Unquantifiables: 6 Tactics to Deepen Fan Passion:

- Surprise player Q&As in the stands

Action: Schedule two to three unannounced mid-game or halftime player appearances in the stands per season. Coordinate timing with team staff and have an MC ready with a wireless mic. Announce it live over the PA as it happens. The unannounced element is critical — fans who capture a surprise moment share it because it feels rare and genuine, which drives organic reach that a planned, promoted appearance rarely generates.

- Fan-voted halftime challenges

Action: Set up a QR-code voting experience accessible from fans' phones before tip-off. Give fans two to three halftime challenge options to vote on. Display running vote totals on the scoreboard during the first half to build anticipation. Execute the winning option live at halftime. This format costs almost nothing to operate but creates sustained engagement across the entire first half because fans are invested in the result before halftime even begins.

- Themed nights celebrating local rivalries with storytelling MCs

Action: Identify two to four culturally resonant local themes per season — a neighborhood rivalry, a regional heritage night, a community milestone. Hire or designate an MC who knows the story and can deliver it live during pre-game or halftime. Promote the theme in advance through your email list and social channels. Themed nights with a strong local narrative consistently outperform generic promotional nights in both attendance and dwell time because they give casual fans a reason to attend that exists independent of the game result.

- Building a "we're building something special" camaraderie

Action: Launch a behind-the-scenes content series sent to your email list every two weeks during the season. Keep it brief — a short video or a written update of two to three paragraphs — and focus on things fans would not otherwise see: a pre-game locker room moment, a front office decision, a stadium improvement underway. Fans who feel like insiders attend more games, bring more people, and convert to season tickets at meaningfully higher rates than fans who only receive promotional messaging.

- Turning casuals into season-ticket evangelists through insider access

Action: Pull a list of fans who attended three or more home games last season without holding a season ticket. Reach out to each one personally — a direct email or a phone call from a staff member, not an automated blast — and invite them to a single exclusive experience: an early-entry preview, a brief stadium tour, or a short meet-and-greet with a player or coach. The personal outreach is the activation. Fans who feel individually recognized by an organization convert to season tickets at a significantly higher rate than those who receive a standard sales message.

- Organic growth fueled by emotional connection not ad spend

Action: After every home game, assign one staff member to capture and post a single authentic fan moment — a photo or a short clip — to your social channels with a personal caption. Tag the fan when possible. Set a 30-minute post-game deadline and treat it as a non-negotiable part of the post-game workflow. Fan-adjacent content consistently outperforms produced advertising content in engagement rate for teams at this budget level, and the only cost is the staff time required to capture it.

Official Partner of the Orlando Pirates (Kia Center)